

The 8 AI Resume Failure Modes

Single-page diagnostic poster. Companion to github.com/Sahme115/chatgpt-resume-before-after-examples.

#	Failure mode	Mini example (BAD)	Fix
1	Symmetric rhythm	"Led the X of Y" three times in a row	Vary lead verbs and lengths
2	Buzzword substitution	leveraged → harnessed	Delete the verb; lead with artifact
3	Invented metric	"Increased efficiency by 47%"	Anchor to dashboard or delete
4	Scope inflation	"Led migration" when one of 5 ICs	Use "Contributed to" / "Co-led"
5	Universal summary	"Passionate professional in dynamic environments"	Name role, years, stack, scope
6	Phantom artifact	"Built v2 platform" (never existed)	Cross-check vs ground truth
7	Em-dash overload	"Built X — delivering Y — across teams"	≤1 em-dash per page
8	Skills as adjectives	"Proficient in cutting-edge tools"	List exact tool names + versions

Six-second recruiter scan path

1. Most recent title + company
2. Top bullet of most recent role
3. Previous title + company
4. First 1–2 words of every bullet on page 1

Quick self-check (30 seconds)

- ☐ Zero Tier-1 buzzwords on page 1
- ☐ No two bullets start with same word
- ☐ At least one bullet under 14 words
- ☐ Every bullet has one recruiter-askable noun
- ☐ No percentage without a verifiable source

If any box fails, the resume still reads as AI-assisted.